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# Silencing Your Inner Critic

*Disarm the voice that puts you down, and grow an inner ally*

4 psychology approaches · tips — by EvaTalk

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## TO BEGIN

# Disarm the voice that puts you down, and grow an inner ally

'You're useless', 'you'll fail', 'everyone does better': your inner critic can be merciless. It disguises itself as clarity, but it harms your self-esteem and paralyzes you.

This guide helps you spot it, counter its attacks, and grow instead a supportive inner voice.

## YOUR INTENTION

The phrase your inner critic repeats most: \_\_\_\_\_

## Where your critical voice comes from

Your inner critic isn't 'the truth': it's an echo of voices heard early (family, school, society), often a clumsy protector that thinks pushing you helps.

Understanding its origin means no longer confusing it with you.

### Example

*Sarah thought her harshness came from her. She recognized a demanding parent's voice — and could start to question it.*

### The origin

Whom or what does your critical voice resemble? Where might you have learned it?

### It's not me

Write: 'This voice isn't the truth — it's a learned habit.'

*Takeaway — Your inner critic is a learned habit, not the truth about you.*

## Spot and counter its attacks

The critic loves distortions: all-or-nothing, 'I should', overgeneralizing ('I always fail'), labeling ('I'm useless'). Naming them already disarms them.

To each attack, you can oppose a fairer, factual answer.

### Example

*'I always fail at everything' deflated the moment Karim listed concrete wins: the generalization didn't hold.*

### Unmask the distortion

Note an attack from your critic · the distortion it uses.

### The factual answer

Oppose a concrete piece of evidence that contradicts it: \_\_\_\_\_

*Takeaway — Name the distortion, oppose a fact — the critic loses its power.*

## From critic to ally

You don't need to destroy yourself to move forward. Instead of a judge, grow an inner coach: demanding maybe, but kind and encouraging.

The same energy, turned to support, takes you much further.

### Example

*Swapping 'move it, you failure' for 'you can do this, one step at a time', Fatou regained the momentum harshness had cut.*

### The ally's voice

Rewrite your most frequent attack as a kind coach.

### My encouragement

An encouraging line to tell yourself in moments of doubt: \_\_\_\_\_

*Takeaway — The same standards, kindly, carry you further.*

## Strengthen your kind voice

A voice grows through repetition. An 'evidence journal' (your wins, positive feedback) and supportive people weaken the critic and feed the ally.

The more you practice, the more the gentle voice becomes your default.

### Example

*By noting one success each evening, Nia watched her critic lose ground week after week.*

### My evidence journal

Note 3 recent wins or positive feedback (even small).

### My circle

Who reflects a fairer image of you? How to spend more time with them?

*Takeaway — Your kind voice grows — a little each day.*

## Key takeaways

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- Your inner critic is a learned habit, not the truth.
- It uses distortions (all-or-nothing, 'I should', overgeneralizing) — name them.
- Oppose each attack with factual evidence.
- Turn the judge into a coach: demanding AND kind.
- Keep an 'evidence journal' of your wins.
- Surround yourself with those who reflect you fairly.

## Your turn

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### My critic

| Its attack | The distortion |
|------------|----------------|
|            |                |
|            |                |
|            |                |
|            |                |

### My ally

| The factual answer | My encouragement |
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YOUR JOURNEY

## Your 4-week plan

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**Week 1**

Spot the origin of my critical voice.

**Week 2**

Unmask its distortions.

**Week 3**

Grow my ally's voice.

**Week 4**

Keep my evidence journal.

YOUR PLAN

## Your action plan

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My 'it's not the truth' line:

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My factual answer:

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My encouragement:

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*You aren't the voice that criticizes you — you're the one who can answer it.*

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool — not therapy. If you're going through a very hard time, reach out to a crisis line in your country. Therapy can help a lot. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.